

Miner No-Hits Tech Modlinski Misses Perfect Game

By MARK LEIBSON

Times Sports Writer

Texas Tech's Red Raiders found out the hard way that when Andy Cohen preaches, everybody should listen.

For the past month, the University of Texas at El Paso baseball coach has said that pitching plus a strong defense will be the Miner's strong points.

After Friday's doubleheader against Texas Tech, there's no doubt that Cohen was speaking the truth.

Matter of fact, Miner pitcher Dan Modlinski made Cohen look like an exceptional prognosticator as Modlinski not only defeated Texas Tech 3-0 in the first game, but he shut down all 22 batters he faced without a hit.

"This is like a dream," said Modlinski following his no-hitter at Dudley Field. "I started thinking about it in the third inning and I sure wanted it because it would have made a perfect birthday present for my mother back in Chicago."

Modlinski lost his perfect game in the first inning when thoughts of a no-hitter were few from none. The second Red Raider batter, Ronnie Matson, looped a fly ball between right and center fields and as center-fielder Joe Pennies and right-fielder Steve Dau converged on the ball, Dau dropped it while criss-crossing with Pennies.

With Matson reaching second with only one out, Modlinski proceeded to strike out Jim Horton and force Mike Bewley to ground out to Art Bravo at second.

"There was a mixup in signals," explained Pennies concerning the error. "Both of us called for it and it was just a matter of not playing together long enough."

The closest Texas Tech came to receiving a hit was in the top of the second when Gary Ashly lined a ball between second and first in which second baseman Bravo made a diving catch.

From then on, Modlinski allowed only two fly balls to leave the infield as he forced eight grounders to the infield, struck out a total of five and forced three Raiders to pop out to the infielders.

"Modlinski said before the game that he felt he could go the entire distance," said Cohen. "But I didn't expect a no-hitter. I was just hoping we would win the game but Modlinski really came on strong."

Critiquing his first appearance of the 1975 season, Modlinski added, "Bravo really helped me out there. He made that great diving catch and also came up with four of five other grounders."

Catcher Joe Dehn also was an instrumental factor in Mod-

linski's performance Friday. "He called a super game. I only had to shake off one of his pitches," added Modlinski.

The no-hitter was Modlinski's fourth of his career. The first was recorded in high school and the other two were pitched at Mayfair Junior College in Chicago, Modlinski's home town.

Through the first few innings, 210-pound right-hander felt shaky although his pitching style look flawless. "I wasn't overpowering today," he said. "So I kept the ball down and they hit a bunch of grounders. My velocity wasn't there during the game and I felt tight in the game."

The seventh inning, probably the most frightening for a hurler with a no-hitter on the line, went like a written script for Modlinski and the Miners.

Matson grounded out to second, Horton flied out to Terry Dillingham at first and Mike Bewley was the victim of strikeouts as the entire Miner bench swarmed Modlinski.

U.T. El Paso's runs all came in the third inning when Dillingham led off with a walk. Keith Rushing moved Dillingham to second with a single and Dave Nance laid down a perfect bunt between third and home as the bases became loaded with no outs.

After Bravo popped to short, Steve Dau lashed a single to center scoring Dillingham and Rushing. With two away, losing Tech hurler John Davidson walked Joe Dehn and then uncorked a wild pitch allowing Nance to score from third.

"Modlinski pitched a hell of a game," praised Cohen who also was pleased with the Miner infielders. "They looked like seasoned kids out there."

In the second game, Texas Tech received more bad hospitality as hurler Ron Wrobel and Wayne Larson combined to trip the visitors 3-1 for a sweep of the doubleheader.

Tech collected its first hit of the year as leadoff batter Bob Wiebe socked a double to right-center, went to third on a fly and scored on Jim Horton's sacrifice fly to right.

But from that point, the Red Raiders under Manager Kal Segrest were held scoreless as Wrobel struck out nine opponents on his way to the 3-1 victory.

U.T. El Paso knotted the score in the bottom of the third. Nance walked with one away, stole second and was then driven around on Dau's two-bagger, the first extra base hit of 1975 for the Miners, to left-center field.

The following inning, the Miners waited until two were away to start a small rally. Keith Rushing walked, went to

second on a wild pitch and scored when Larson cracked a double to left.

An insurance run was credited to the Miners in the sixth as Pennies led off with a base on balls. Rushing sacrificed him to second and Larson socked his second hit of the game down the left field like scoring Pennies.

"The Miners simply beat us with the hit," said Cohen.

defensively," said Cohen. "The Miners were a better club with the bat today. I don't know if there was that much difference with out pitchers and theirs."

Summing up the twin killing, Cohen barked out, "This is a hell of a way to start the season."

Saturday, both teams indulge in another doubleheader beginning at 1 p.m. at Dudley Field. Roy Stringer and George Landreth are slated to see mound work for the Miners while Texas Tech plans on starting Kim Hunter in the opener followed with Jerry Lee.

Texas Tech		Miners	
ab	r h bi	ab	r h bi
Cohen if	3 0 0 0	Bravo 2b	3 0 1 0
Matson ss	3 0 0 0	Dau rf	3 0 1 2
Horton cf	3 0 0 0	Villarreal 3b	3 0 0 0
Bewley rf	3 0 0 0	Dehn c	2 0 0 0
Ashly lb	2 0 0 0	Stringer dh	3 0 0 0
Wiebe 2b	2 0 0 0	Pennies cf	3 0 1 0
Loler c	2 0 0 0	Sittingham 1b	1 0 0 0
Nikkel dh	2 0 0 0	Rushing if	2 1 1 0
McMillan 3b	2 0 0 0	Nance ss	2 1 1 0
Davidson p	0 0 0 0	Modlinski p	0 0 0 0
Totals	22 0 0 0	Totals	21 3 5 2
Tech	0 0 0 0	000 000 0-0	
Miners	003 000 x-3		
E-Dau, Matson LBO-Tech 1, Miners 4			
IP H R ER BB SO			
Davidson (L, 0-1)	6 3 3 3 3		
Modlinski (W, 1-0)	7 0 0 0 0 5		
T-1:41 WP-Davidson			

Texas Tech		Miners	
ab	r h bi	ab	r h bi
Wiebe 2b	4 1 2 0	Morris 2b	4 0 0 0
Matson ss	3 0 0 0	Dau rf	3 0 2 1
Horton if	2 0 1 1	Villarreal 2b	3 0 1 0
Bewley rf	2 0 0 0	Dillingham 1b	3 0 0 0
Castle cf	2 0 0 0	Pennies cf	2 1 0 0
Loler c	3 0 0 0	Rushing dh	1 1 0 0
Sims dh	3 0 1 0	Larson c	3 0 2 2
McMillan 3b	2 0 0 0	Walsh if	2 0 0 0
Nikkel ph	1 0 1 0	Nance ss	2 1 1 0
Johnson pr	0 0 0 0	Wrobel p	0 0 0 0
Ashby lb	2 0 1 0	Totals	23 3 6 3
Morrin p	0 0 0 0		
Williams p	0 0 0 0		
Lepori p	0 0 0 0		
Totals	24 1 4 1		
Tech	100 000 0-1		
Miners	001 101 x-3		
LBO-Miners 7, Tech 4. 2B-Wiebe, Dau, Larson, Nance. SB-Nance, Horton. SF-Horton			
IP H R ER BB SO			

Morrin (L, 0-1)	5 4 2 2 3 3
Williams	2 2 1 1 1 1
Lepori	3 3 0 0 0 0
Wrobel (W, 1-0)	7 6 1 1 2 9
T-1:32 WP-Morrin	

Meunch Honored

LAS CRUCES, N.M. (AP) — Sports editor Joe Meunch of the Las Cruces Sun-News has been named sports writer of the year in New Mexico for 1974 by the National Association of Sportscasters and Sportswriters.